LESSON 1

Hot Cross Buns

A London street cry: bakers sang it to sell hot spiced buns on Good Friday.

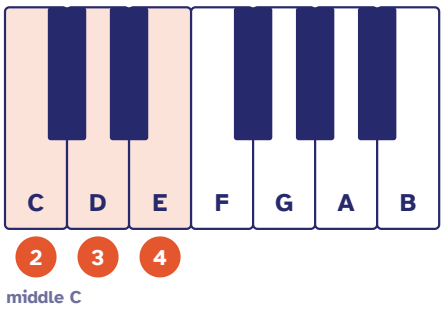
IN THIS SONG **three notes: E D C** **steps down** **walk and run-ning** **fingers 4 3 2**

LISTEN FIRST
Scan the code: listen to the whole song once, then hum along the second time.

THE WOW MOMENT
Your first song with a band. Three notes, and you are already playing with drums and bass: scan the code, choose the band, and play on top. Then open your **passport**: Lesson 1 issues it.

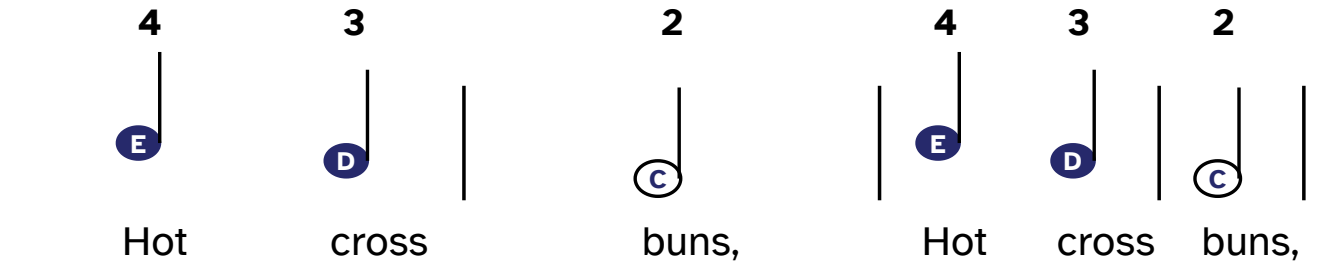
1 Meet the song

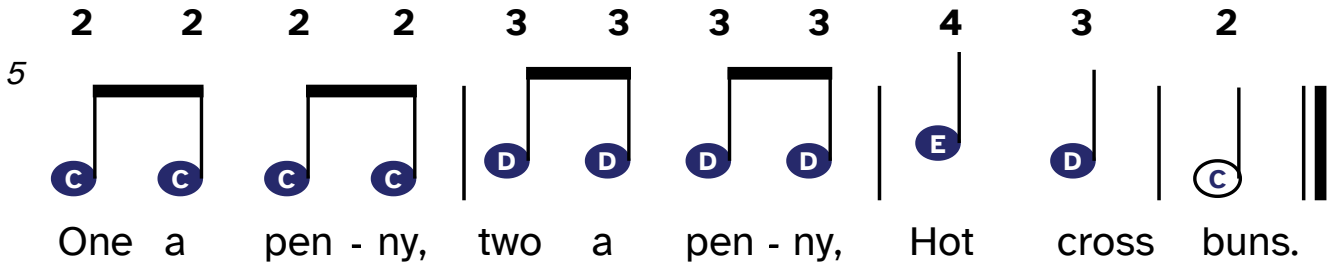
Listen, pointing to each note. Sing it with the words, then on the letter names.



Your hand. Right hand: finger 2 on middle C, 3 on D, 4 on E: the three middle fingers.

Steps down. E, D, C: each note is the next key down, and on the page each sits a step lower.





- [ ] Listened and pointed
- [ ] Sang it with the words
- [ ] Sang the letter names

2 Take it apart

The same song, one piece at a time: first its rhythm, then its notes.

THE RHYTHM

Say the words in time, then clap and count: clap on the coral numbers, hold through the grey ones.

THE BEAT

Count 1 2 in every bar, steady as a clock: two beats a bar.
Walk on a beat; run two quick notes in one beat: say *pen-ny*, count *1 +*.

THE NOTES



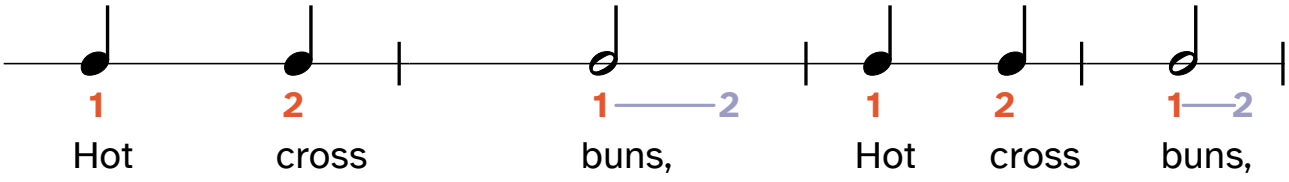
crotchet: walk
1 beat

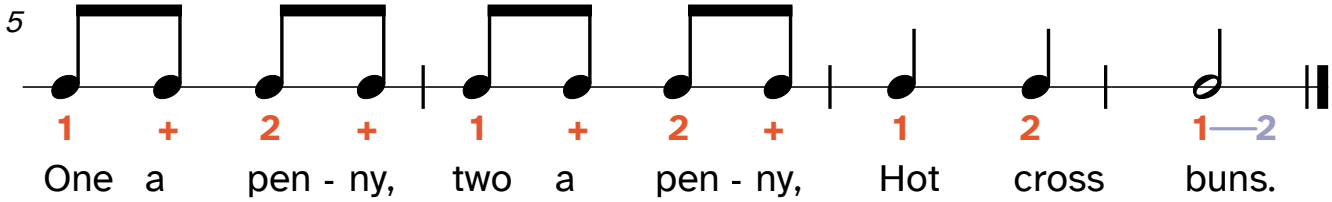


two quavers: run-ning
1 beat



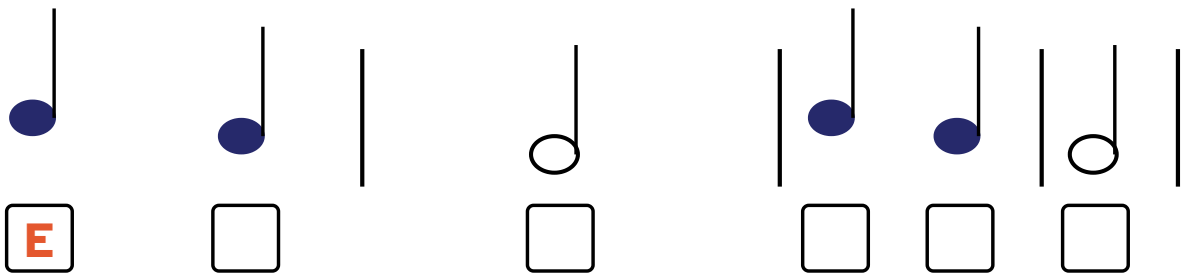
minim
2 beats

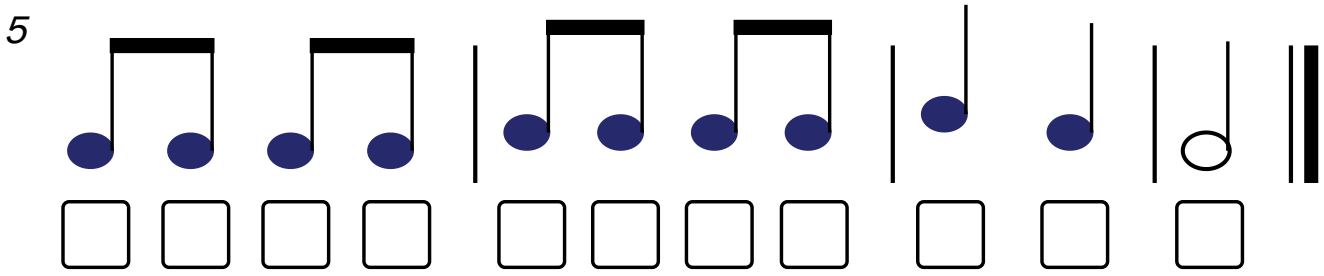




THE NOTES

Now the notes are empty. Write E, D or C in each box, then sing it on the letter names.





SPOT THE MISTAKE

One note here is wrong. Play it, then the same bars on page 1: which note sounds wrong? Circle it.



☐ **Said it in time** ☐ **Clapped it** ☐ **Wrote the letters** ☐ **Spotted the mistake**

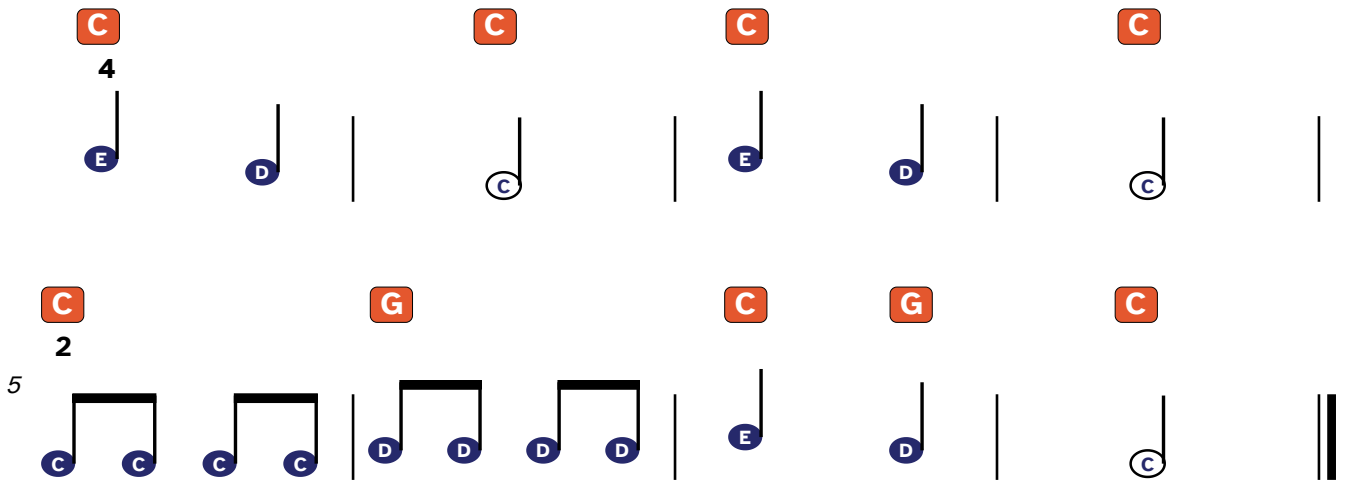
3 Lead sheet

A lead sheet is how band players read: the tune, and above it only the chord names. You play the tune; the band on the listening page plays the names.

THE NAMES

A name tells the band which chord to play under the tune. Your left hand learns to play them from Lesson 4.

C G



1 Point to each name as the music reaches it

2 Play the tune with the band (the listening page): the band plays the names

3 Say the names out loud in time while the band plays

4 · CHECK

I can play it: colour a step each time you climb

	With letters	No letters	With the band	Fast
The tune				
With the band				

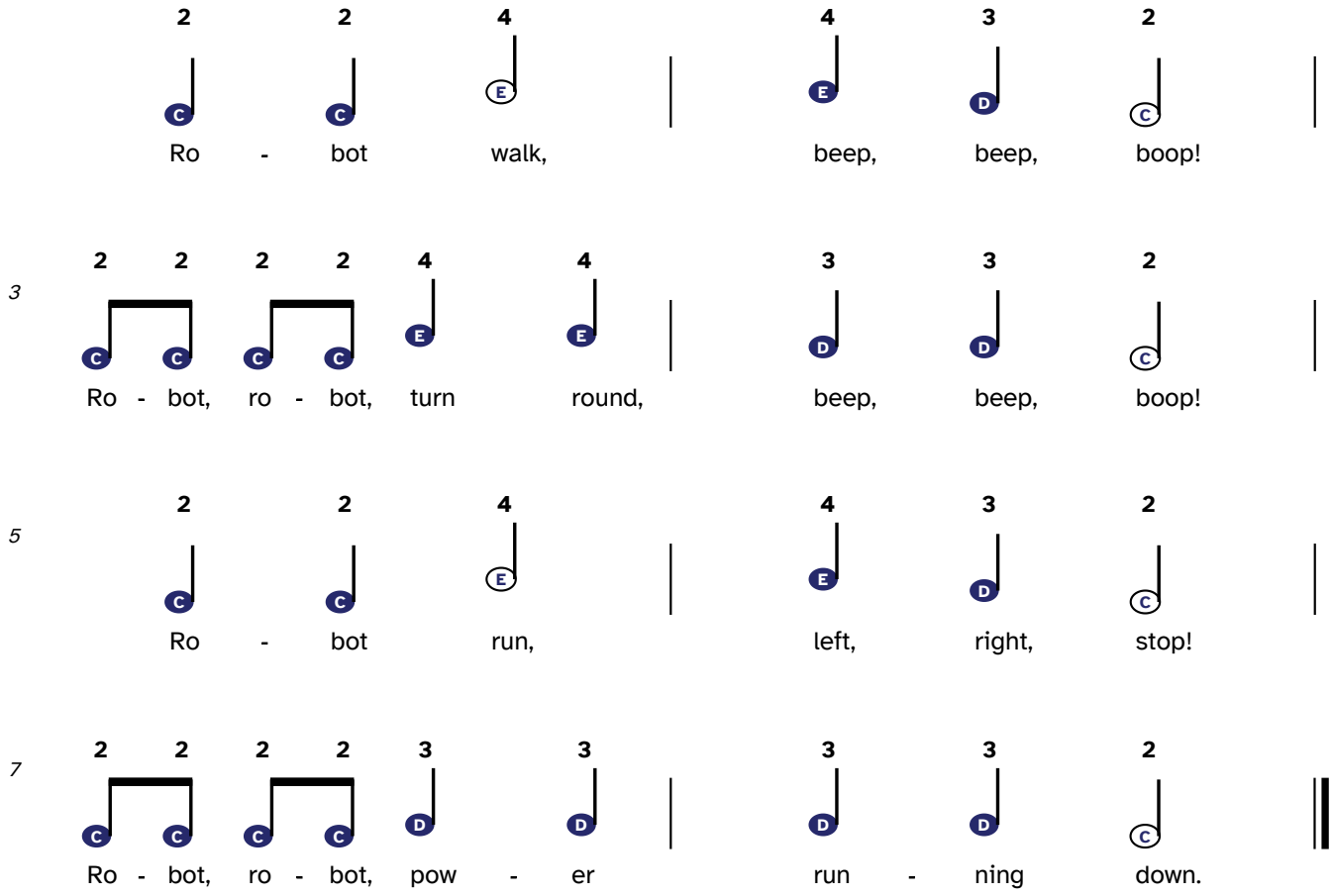
LISTEN BACK ☐ **I recorded it** ☐ **It sounded right**

+ More to play

The same three keys, a new way: a robot that walks with the band. Then make a tune of your own.

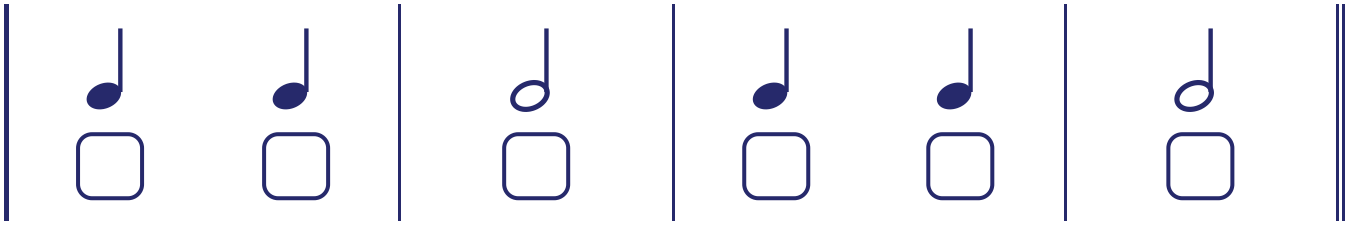
ROBOT WALK

A robot on three keys: stiff, steady steps. Say the words, then play it with the band.



YOUR OWN TUNE

Write a letter in each box, then play your tune. Give it a name: ☐



MAKE IT YOURS

Pick one and play the whole song that way. Record it on a phone and listen back: does it sound the way you meant?

- ☐ **Robot: every note short and stiff**
- ☐ **Giant: slow and heavy, big footsteps**
- ☐ **Mouse: fast and tiny**

5 MINUTES AT HOME

1. Listen to the song once
2. Right hand, twice
3. Lead sheet: the tune with the band
4. Robot Walk with the band

☐ M ☐ T ☐ W ☐ T ☐ F ☐ S ☐ S

- ☐ **Played Robot Walk**
- ☐ **Played my own tune**